

AMAZON · SYSTEMS

Amazon Books: Convergence Project

Unifying the books experience across Amazon with systems thinking that scales across feature teams.

Lead UX Designer
deannaglaze.com

UX DESIGN

SYSTEMS THINKING

OVERVIEW

Amazon was consolidating three publishing tools into one platform. Publishers managed their catalogs across Vendor Central, Publish to Kindle, and Kindle Enterprise Publishing (KEP) — different interfaces, different conventions, and partial feature sets. The mandate: make KEP the platform, on a single code base, with nothing lost. I led research, audit, information architecture, and content design.

MY ROLE

Lead UX Designer

Mapping workflows & IA

User research

Ideation & conceptual design

Prototyping

THE TEAM

Sole designer on the project

1 product manager

5 engineers

1 technical account manager

New P2K

publish to kindle

WELCOME TO THE NEW PUBLISH TO KINDLE

What's new:

1. Improved user interface and visual design
2. Improved navigation that makes it easier to find what you need
3. Universal search to help you quickly find what you're looking for
4. Quick links that provide access to Vendor Central links like reporting and your payment reports.

Help us improve your Publish to Kindle experience by [sending us feedback](#).

1

Q Title, Author, ISBN, Ref ID, etc...

2

3

4

File upload status

Title status

Most recent file upload

File name	File type	Upload date	Uploaded by	Status	Download report
9781489287564.jpg	Cover image	3/28/2019	mary@harpers.com	Success (1/1)	Download
Metadata_Only_HarperCollins_US...	Metadata	3/28/2019	john@harpers.com	Success (1/1)	Download
9780008169091.apub	Content	3/24/2019	john@harpers.com	Failed (0/1)	Download
HarperCollins_US_0080692302.xml	Metadata	3/24/2019	mary@harpers.com	Success (1/1)	Download
9781636169091.apub	Content	3/24/2019	john@harpers.com	Failed (0/1)	Download

Manage your catalog

publish to kindle

© 1996-2017, Amazon.com, Inc. or its affiliates. All Rights Reserved. Amazon and Kindle are trademarks of Amazon.com Inc. or its affiliates.

HELP
Learn More
Contact Us
Send us feedback

LEGAL
Terms & Conditions
Program Guidelines

Current P2K in Vendor Central

amazon

publish to kindle

WELCOME TO THE NEW PUBLISH TO KINDLE

What's new:

1. Improved user interface and visual design
2. Improved navigation that makes it easier to find what you need
3. Universal search to help you quickly find what you're looking for
4. Quick links that provide access to Vendor Central links like reporting and your payment reports.

Help us improve your Publish to Kindle experience by [sending us feedback](#).

1

Q Title, Author, ISBN, Ref ID, etc...

2

3

4

File upload status

Title status

Most recent file upload

File name	File type	Upload date	Uploaded by	Status	Download report
9781489287564.jpg	Cover image	3/28/2019	mary@harpers.com	Success (1/1)	Download
Metadata_Only_HarperCollins_US...	Metadata	3/28/2019	john@harpers.com	Success (1/1)	Download
9780008169091.apub	Content	3/24/2019	john@harpers.com	Failed (0/1)	Download
HarperCollins_US_0080692302.xml	Metadata	3/24/2019	mary@harpers.com	Success (1/1)	Download
9781636169091.apub	Content	3/24/2019	john@harpers.com	Failed (0/1)	Download

Manage your catalog

amazon

© 1996-2017, Amazon.com, Inc. or its affiliates. All Rights Reserved. Amazon and Kindle are trademarks of Amazon.com Inc. or its affiliates.

HELP
Learn More
Contact Us
Send us feedback

LEGAL
Terms & Conditions
Program Guidelines

Side-by-side comparison of the redesigned Publish to Kindle dashboard and the legacy Vendor Central experience

THE CHALLENGE

Consolidating without shipping the old friction

Publishers jumped between platforms to do one job. Tasks were duplicated, errors were common, and training and support costs were high.

The business mandate was 100% feature parity. But Vendor Central was never built for publishers managing thousands of titles — parity meant porting known usability issues into the new platform. Leadership was focused on parity and wary of anything beyond it, including fixes to problems everyone agreed existed.

The real problem was not consolidation. It was how to consolidate without intentionally shipping the old friction.

Pre-convergence platforms

amazon
Publish To Kindle

View Titles

Showing 1 to 20 of 13290 results

Reference ID	Problems	Title	Author	ASIN	eISBN	pISBN	Prices	Status	Converted By	Released
HM04	1 warning	First Aid for the USMLE Step 2 CK, Tenth Edition	IMC4	B01J2CC8PV			100.000 USD	Print Replica		1/1/2018
HM03	1 warning	First Aid for the USMLE Step 3, Fifth Edition	HM03	B01J2D82H4			100.000 USD	Print Replica		1/1/2018
9780147529735	2 errors	Fast	Anderson, Lindsay	B07N2Q8V44	9780147529735	978014752...		Print Replica		3/7/2017
9781438703496	2 errors	Be Ready (1 & 2) (Thomas Nelson)	The Storm, Inc.	B07N8C7D08	9781438703496	978143870...		Print Replica		6/1/2018
HM02	1 warning	First Aid Cases for the USMLE Step 1, Fourth Edition	HM02	B01J2889YF			100.000 USD	Print Replica		1/1/2018
HM01	1 warning	First Aid for the USMLE Step 1, Tenth, Tenth edition	HM01	B01J2889YF			100.000 USD	Print Replica		1/1/2018
Preorder_HM_20...	1 warning	Preorder_HM_20...	Preorder	B07C5A737			100.000 USD	Publisher		11/9/2018
Preorder_HM_20...	1 warning	Preorder_HM_20...	Preorder	B07C5A737			100.000 USD	Publisher		11/9/2018
Preorder_HM_20...	2 errors	Preorder_HM_20...	Preorder	B07C5A737			100.000 USD	Publisher		11/9/2018
Preorder_HM_20...	2 errors	Preorder_HM_20...	Preorder	B07C5A737			100.000 USD	Publisher		11/9/2018
Preorder_HM_20...	2 errors	Preorder_HM_20...	Preorder	B07C5A737			100.000 USD	Publisher		11/9/2018
Simon_Press	1 warning	What This Book	Simon_Press	B07N8C7D08			100.000 USD	Print Replica		12/8/2017
CoverFootnote		CoverFootnote	Berning, Bruce	B07N8C7D08	9781438703496		1.000 USD	Publisher		7/24/2012
9781438703496	1 warning	The Holistic Taylor	HolisticTaylor, David	B07N8C7D08	9781438703496			Publisher		6/1/2012
DUPR_978080806...	2 errors	O Mannu	Pompeya, Raul	B01J2D82H4	978080806377	978080806...		Print Replica		3/13/2013
9781442437812	2 errors	Robinson Crusoe	Defoe, Daniel	B008WFLJ8H	9781442437812	978080806...	6.999 USD			2/14/2012
9781442438274	2 errors	Just So Stories	Kipling, Rudyard	B008WFLJ8H	9781442438274	978080806...	5.999 USD			3/6/2012
9781613630242	1 warning	Leading Successful Change & Stay in	Shaw, Gregory P.;	B07N8C7D08	9781613630242	978161363...		Publisher		2/5/2013
EqualTune03	1 warning	Dakin Activity: The Dynamic Play of	B07N8C7D08	9780997716283	9780997716283	9780997716283		Publisher		6/1/2018
Tune03P02Q2	1 warning	Dakin Activity: The Dynamic Play of	B07N8C7D08	9780997716283	9780997716283	9780997716283		Publisher		11/1/2018

kindle enterprise publishing
Catalog Manager

Showing 1 to 20 of 39 results

Title	Author	Status	Problems	Reference ID	eISBN	Prices	Payment plan	Rights
Home Scenes and Heart Studies	Grace Aguilar	Live		58722		2.998 USD		Enhanced
Pourquoi l'atmosphère est religieuse	Levine, Bernard	Suppressed	2 errors	testRunWO...	9781547554...	3.998 USD		Enhanced
Pourquoi l'atmosphère est religieuse	Levine, Bernard	Suppressed	2 errors	9781547554805	9781547554...	3.998 USD		Enhanced
US RevShare Test 1	US RevShare	Limited availability	2 errors	US_rev_shar...		7.008 USD		Enhanced
What Outfit Buddy?	T. Howard Kelly	Limited availability		57271_PhOnd		1.038 USD		Standard
Test Title	Deanna Glaze	Suppressed	2 errors	Ref101		9.998 USD		Enhanced
Tony The Trump Right is Might	Horatio Alger, Jr.	Live		58730		2.998 USD		Enhanced
Double Play: A Story of Softball and Baseball	Ralph Henry Barbour	Live		58752		6.158 USD		Standard
An Everyday Girl: A Story	Amy Ella Blanchard	Live		58725		1.998 USD		Standard
Bertrand of Brittany	Queen, Elery	Live		58703	9781504003...	5.998 USD		Enhanced

Pre-convergence platforms: Publish to Kindle inside Vendor Central alongside the separate KEP catalog manager

Making the cost of parity visible

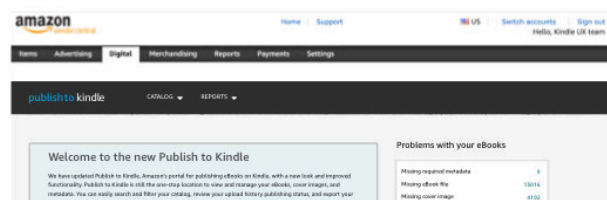
I built a comprehensive audit comparing all three platforms feature by feature. It documented every inconsistency in navigation, labeling, and actions, and it named the pain points in bulk workflows, metadata entry, and content validation. Each issue came with a recommendation.

I took it to engineering before presenting to leadership. Once engineers could see the actual scope of what parity would cost, we collectively prioritized the fixes. That alignment is what convinced leadership to trust our judgment on what to fix and what to carry forward.

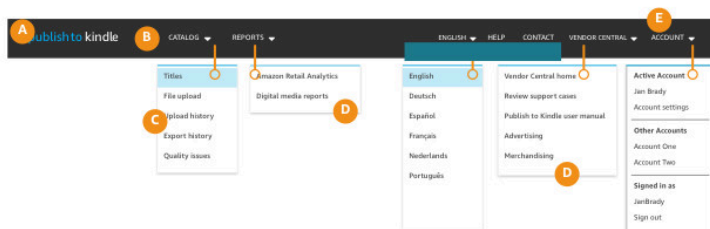
P0: PRIMARY NAVIGATION

P2K Beta release

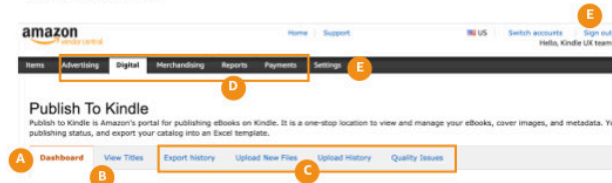
Existing implementation of P2K will remain under the vendor central primary navigation until all pages are off KPSSW and pages are routing through the new stack.



New P2K



Current P2K in Vendor Central



NOTES:

A. Dashboard and Publish to Kindle branding: Maintaining the P2K name. The P2K home/landing page is the dashboard. To align with KEP and follow navigation best practices, we are not duplicating the dashboard label in primary navigation. Publishers will click on the "publish to kindle" logo to return to the home state.

B. Catalog: We are following best practices (guidance from our content strategist) to not mix verb-based and noun-based navigation.

C. Export history, Upload New Files, Upload History, Quality Issues: Removing P2K from within Vendor Central (and their primary navigation), allows us to create a primary navigation that is P2K-specific. "Your titles" is a container (parent) of all of the actions (children) that exist in the current P2K navigation (i.e., File upload, Upload history, Upload new files, etc.) so it makes sense to correct this in the information architecture.

Note: we interviewed the navigation with TS Publishers and performed usability testing with six-plus Publishers and found no confusion regarding this change.

D. Vendor Central links: In the navigation, we are providing a way back to Vendor Central links that Publishers may need to access as part of their workflow such as Amazon Retail Analytics and Advertising.

Note: During usability sessions, almost all of the Publisher participants noted that many of these VC links are not relevant to their workflow. We recommend as a fast-follow contextualizing these links (by customization?) to reduce noise and help our Publishers quickly get to what they need.

E. Settings and Account: Following KEP model, we are simplifying these links into one navigation item called "Account". Within Account one can access settings, switch accounts, and sign out.

Primary navigation redesign: a P2K-specific navigation replacing the Vendor Central wrapper, annotated with research findings

APPROACH

Structured around how publishers think

Research — Interviews with Tier 5 and 5+ publishers, our most advanced users with the most complex workflows. Their language shaped the IA, the terminology, and the interaction patterns.

Information architecture — Grouped tasks by user goal rather than by legacy platform origin, so the structure reflected how publishers think about their catalog instead of how Amazon's tools happen to be built.

Reduce load, preserve familiarity — New patterns mirrored flows publishers already knew but fixed the hierarchy: batch editing, simpler metadata input, clear status visibility.

Co-design and testing — Walked flows live with publishers, refined against their edge cases, then ran structured usability testing across occasional users and power users.

New P2K

publish to kindle **A** DASHBOARD CATALOG REPORTING ENGLISH ▼ HELP CONTACT ACCOUNT ▼

B Welcome to the new Publish to Kindle

C File upload status

D Title status

1 Search bar

2 Upload files button

3 Quick links

4 Most recent file upload table

Current P2K in Vendor Central

amazon **A** DASHBOARD CATALOG REPORTING ENGLISH ▼ HELP CONTACT US

B Welcome to the new Publish to Kindle

C File upload status

D Title status

1 Search bar

2 Upload files button

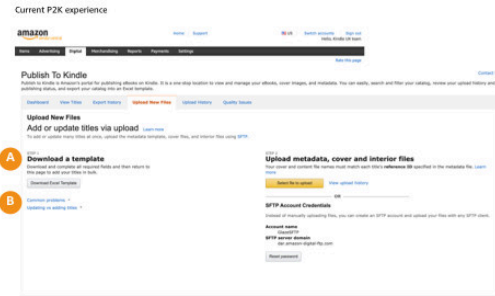
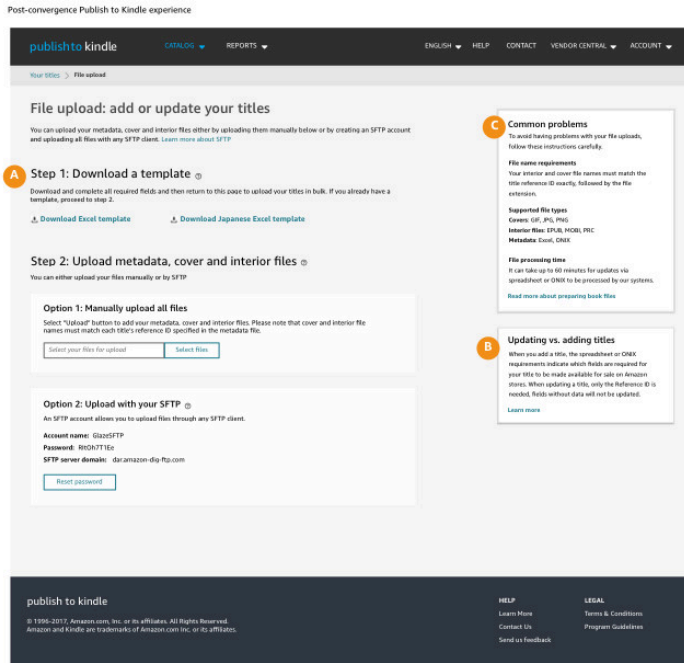
3 Quick links

4 Most recent file upload table

Annotated comparison of the converged Publish to Kindle dashboard against the current Vendor Central experience

In the legacy system, publishers navigated multiple tabs just to upload a cover and its content files. I consolidated the related actions into a single view, which matched how publishers actually think about a title.

FILE UPLOAD



NOTES

A. Download template - The current experience suggests a process in steps but that is not the case. Unless Publishers are new to downloading, they are likely to already have a title populated template they're working from. To address this, we rearranged the page hierarchy to reflect upload options and put a download link with the educational text under the page title.

B. Common problems / Updating vs. adding titles - The current P2K has help content hidden. For Publishers who are not as familiar with upload requirements, we see no value in hiding this information. Surfacing requirements and file processing time sets expectations immediately and may help reduce errors in file uploads.

IMPACT

From strict parity to funded fixes

Changed what got funded — The audit moved leadership off strict parity. Usability fixes they had deferred indefinitely were scoped, prioritized, and built.

Foundation for the unified backend — Validated IA, scalable patterns, and specs written against engineering requirements. Development of the consolidated system was built on this work.

Reduced ambiguity for engineering — Aligning design with the unified backend and documenting it thoroughly let the team move faster with fewer open questions.

Future vision

Alongside convergence, I developed a concept for one workflow across every book format. Publishers had long been frustrated that digital lived in KEP, print lived in Vendor Central, and audio lived in Audible.

I designed a unified dashboard, catalog manager, and title detail view, and shared them with publishers, who responded strongly to seeing their feedback taken seriously. The work required cross-organizational collaboration and is still ongoing inside the Books organization.

The screenshot shows a unified dashboard for a book titled "The Strange Journey of Alice Pendelbury". The interface is divided into several sections:

- Top Navigation:** Includes "book publishing", "OVERVIEW", "YOUR TITLES", "REPORTING", a language selector (EN), "HELP", and a user profile (JAN BRADY).
- Breadcrumbs:** "Your titles" > "The Strange Journey of Alice Pendelbury".
- Format Tabs:** "Print" (selected), "Kindle", and "+ Add format".
- Left Sidebar:** "Book Details" (selected), "Author", "Pricing", "Rights", and "Advanced Reader".
- Main Content Area:**
 - Book Details:** Includes a book cover image, title, contributors (Author(s): Marc Levy, Chris Murray; Editor: Dorothy Allison; Illustrator: Gary Baseman), and content files (bookManuscript).
 - Book Description:** A paragraph about Alice Pendelbury's life and the book's plot.
 - Keywords:** Adventure, Quirky, Travel.
- Right Sidebar:**
 - Title details:** Ref ID (Book124), ASIN (B07KVLPHYDQ), Language (English), Imprint (Imprint Title), eISBN (e132498232), and BISAC Categories (FIC019000).
 - Publication details:** Release date (03/10/2019) and Initial Publication date (02/10/2018).
 - Title Status:** A "LIVE" status indicator and a "Last update" message from Jan Brady on 06/10/2019.
 - WEEKLY SALES:** A line chart showing sales trends from 7/22 to 7/28, with a peak on 7/27.

At the bottom, there is a footer with copyright information (© 1996-2017, Amazon.com, Inc. or its affiliates), a "HELP" section (Learn More, Contact Us), and a "LEGAL" section (Terms & Conditions, Program Guidelines).

Unified title detail concept: one page per book with print, Kindle, and other formats as tabs, alongside title details, status, and sales

THANKS FOR READING

Let's connect

Interested in collaborating or learning more about my work? Let's chat.

PORTFOLIO	deannaglaze.com
CONTACT	deannaglaze.com/contact
LINKEDIN	linkedin.com/in/deannaglaze

DEANNA GLAZE · PRODUCT DESIGN LEADER